

Fall 2026 Parent Letter

October 5, 2026 · Faith · Seek Truth · Know Thyself · Serve Others

Dear Parents,

Greetings in the Lord! As autumn arrives, Joy Academy extends its warmest holiday greetings to you and your family. May your home be filled with happiness, health, and peace.

It has been a month since the start of school. We are encouraged to see the focus, effort, and vibrant energy our students bring to their online classrooms. At our recent Curriculum Night, we had the pleasure of gathering with parents to share the school's educational philosophy and discuss this semester's plans and hopes. Thank you sincerely for your time, attention, and support!

1. Our Mission: Nurturing a Godly Next Generation

Our educational mission is to **nurture a Godly next generation, equipping students to become professionals in every field and the light and salt of the world.** We care not only about academic achievement, but also about the formation of each student's life and character. As they enter society, we hope they will have both strong professional abilities and steadfast faith and good character, bringing light and blessing to the fields they serve.

2. Building a Strong, Transparent School: WASC Accreditation and Our New Website

- **WASC accreditation application submitted:** This past summer, the school formally submitted its accreditation application to the Western Association of Schools and Colleges (WASC). This marks a milestone in our efforts to strengthen school operations, pursue international standards, and uphold rigorous academic management.
- **Our new official website is live:** We invite you to visit and bookmark **joyacademy.online**. The website offers course information, teaching updates, and

important announcements, and will serve as an important resource for learning about our school.

3. High School Academics and College Planning: Seeking Truth, Self-Discovery, and Academic Challenge

This semester, we have further expanded and refined our high school curriculum to support students' academic development and college planning at every grade level:

- **For 11th graders: College Counseling** Junior year is a pivotal point on the path to college applications. This course goes beyond test planning and application guidance; it invites students into a journey of self-discovery and seeking truth in their academic lives:
 - **Seek Truth:** Students are encouraged to ask, “What is true? What is right? What are the patterns? What is the evidence?”
 - **Know Thyself:** Students explore, “Who am I? What are my strengths and areas for growth? What do I enjoy? What am I afraid of? What inspires me?”
 - **Serve Others:** Students consider, “What can I do for others, my family, and society? Whom am I called to serve?”

These three dimensions will run throughout the college counseling course, helping students find a future direction aligned with their calling and faith.

- **New advanced AP courses for eligible high school students:** This semester we have added advanced courses, including **AP Microeconomics** and **AP Calculus**, open to high school students who meet the enrollment requirements. These courses offer greater academic challenge, develop logical thinking and disciplined study habits, and help students build a strong foundation for admission to highly selective colleges.

4. Character Formation: The Cardinal Virtues and This Semester's Theme

Knowledge gives us power, while character gives us direction. This semester, we will continue to deepen our character education:

- **Practicing the Cardinal Virtues, alongside faith, hope, and love:**
 - **Prudence:** Learning to discern, think, and choose wisely;
 - **Temperance:** Learning self-control, rather than being ruled by desires, weaknesses, or emotions;
 - **Justice:** Learning to treat others rightly and to do what is right;
 - **Fortitude:** Continuing forward with perseverance, even when facing difficulty.

- **Deepening our semester theme — “We See Each Other”:** Our whole-school reading selection this semester is *Wonder*, a book especially suited to our students. We hope to bridge the distance created by screens and help students truly learn to “see each other” in online conversations and everyday interactions:
 - **Seeing the good:** Noticing others' strengths, gifts, and good character, and affirming the thoughtful words, actions, and ideas around us;
 - **Seeing needs:** Recognizing when classmates need help and support, noticing what they enjoy and where they are growing, and responding with thoughtful love and encouragement;
 - **Seeing progress:** Guiding students away from unhelpful comparisons and toward growth: “Compared with last week, you have improved in...” We celebrate even small changes in one another's actions and thinking;
 - **Seeing reasons for gratitude:** Recognizing the help and kindness we receive, reflecting on the words and actions that positively shape our lives, and cultivating grateful hearts.

5. Our Hopes for a Strong Home-School Partnership

A child's growth in character and academic learning depends on the shared commitment of home and school. In our partnership with families, we hope to work together around these priorities:

1. **Set long-term goals:** Talk with your children about goals for the future. Every climb brings visible growth. Without a goal, a traveler may keep going in circles; with a goal, a climber can keep crossing new heights with courage and resolve.
2. **Encourage mastery:** Help children understand that mastery is more than “knowing how”; it is being able to do something without having to stop and think it through each time. Mastery is not about one moment of perfection, but about consistent, dependable ability.
3. **Focus on the small details:** Details are not trivial; they are the only path to mastery.
 - **Recitation** helps truth take root in the heart, so there is no need to look it up at the last minute;
 - **Remembering** makes the right response instinctive, without hesitation or wavering;

- **Repetition** makes good character a habit, rather than something that requires constant restraint.

4. **Build healthy habits and maintain communication between home and school:**

- Help children develop healthy routines for sleep and study, with enough rest and a focused learning space. Pay attention to the learning process, not only the results, and nurture their curiosity and motivation to learn independently.
- **Communicate proactively:** Stay in regular contact with teachers. Keep informed about your child's online learning and emotional well-being so that we can work together to support their growth.

As Deuteronomy 8:2–3 says:

“Remember how the Lord your God led you all the way in the wilderness these forty years, to humble and test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep his commands. He humbled you, causing you to hunger and then feeding you with manna, which neither you nor your ancestors had known, to teach you that we do not live on bread alone but on every word that comes from the mouth of the Lord.”

May we remember together with our families how God guides and shapes our children as they grow. May we care not only for their physical and academic needs, but also nurture their souls with God's Word and wisdom.

Education is a journey on which home and school move forward together. Thank you again for your trust and partnership. Let us walk alongside one another this new semester and witness each child's growth in character and learning!

May the Lord's abundant grace fill your home, and may your family rejoice in His peace.

Joy Academy Online

October 2026